

Employee Leave Policy (2024 Edition)

article_id: hr-leave-002 | policy_area: leave | effective_date: 2024-01-01 | last_updated: 2024-01-01

1. Overview

This article describes Meridian Robotics' employee leave policy as it applies to all full-time employees, effective **2024-01-01**. It covers leave entitlements, the request process, and carry-over rules. This edition supersedes the 2023 edition of this policy; HR business partners should use the entitlement numbers in this article for any leave taken on or after 2024-01-01.

2. Eligibility

All full-time employees are eligible for leave from their date of joining. Interns and contractors are not covered by this policy and should refer to their engagement agreement instead. (Unchanged from the 2023 edition.)

3. Leave Entitlements

Leave is split across five categories. Casual, sick, and earned leave entitlements increased from the 2023 edition; a new Bereavement Leave category was also added.

3.1 Casual Leave

The annual entitlement is **15 days** (increased from 12 days in 2023). Casual leave must still be requested at least 3 business days in advance through the HR portal.

3.2 Sick Leave

The annual entitlement is **12 days** (increased from 10 days in 2023). Sick leave may be reported on the day of absence; a doctor's note is required for absences longer than 2 consecutive days.

3.3 Earned Leave

Earned leave accrues at a rate of 1.75 days per completed month of service, for an annual entitlement of **21 days** (increased from 18 days in 2023). Earned leave requests must be submitted at least 5 business days in advance.

3.4 Parental Leave

Parental leave remains **26 weeks** for the primary caregiver and **2 weeks** for the secondary caregiver (unchanged from 2023).

3.5 Bereavement Leave (New)

Employees are entitled to **5 days** of paid bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member (spouse, parent, child, or sibling), and **2 days** for an extended family member. This category did not exist under the 2023 edition.

4. Requesting Leave

Unchanged from the 2023 edition: all leave requests (except same-day sick leave) are submitted through the HR portal under "Time Off > New Request," and auto-escalate to the manager's manager after 3 business days if unconfirmed.

5. Carry-Over Rules

Unused earned leave carries over to the next calendar year, up to a maximum of **12 days** (increased from 10 days in 2023). Casual, sick, and bereavement leave do not carry over and expire at the end of the calendar year.

6. What Changed from the 2023 Policy

Leave Type	2023 Entitlement	2024 Entitlement
Casual Leave	12 days	15 days
Sick Leave	10 days	12 days
Earned Leave	18 days	21 days
Parental Leave	26 weeks (primary)	26 weeks (primary), unchanged
Bereavement Leave	Not offered	5 days
Earned Leave Carry-Over Cap	10 days	12 days

7. Frequently Asked Questions

- **I was told casual leave is 12 days -- is that right?** No, that was the 2023 entitlement. As of 2024-01-01 casual leave is 15 days.
- **Can I take casual leave and sick leave in the same week?** Yes, they are tracked independently.
- **Is bereavement leave paid?** Yes, at full base salary.

8. Escalation

Disputes about leave balances should be escalated to the HR Shared Services desk, which will review the employee's accrual history against the entitlements in this edition and issue a correction within 5 business days if warranted.

Cross-Article References

- Supersedes **Employee Leave Policy (2023 Edition)** -- do not use 2023 entitlement numbers for leave taken on or after 2024-01-01.
- See **Remote Work Policy** for how remote work days interact with leave requests.
- See **Performance Review Policy** for how extended leave affects review-cycle timing.